

To keep malware at bay:

- **Software Updates** – Make sure all your software is up-to-date as most ransomware attacks have known to happen with operating systems that have not been updated. In addition to the operating system, also make sure your anti-virus software database and browser are up-to-date. Make sure you never download pirated software from the internet as it may contain malware.
- **Take offline periodic backups of your data.** Daily backups are the best way to avoid any data loss in case of an attack.
- **Make sure you download from credible sources** – Never download software or any content from unknown websites. Never click on random ads that pop up with irresistible offers as these are the best places for hackers to leave adware that will hack your system data.
- **Never join public networks** as there are higher chances of a hacker accessing your system and injecting a virus program that can affect your system and other connected devices. The virus can also crash your system completely.

Phishing scams are used by hackers to make users enter their personal information with sensitive data like email addresses, contact numbers, credit card details, etc. Hackers create offer emails and special discount newsletters that tempt users with irresistible discounts and force them to enter their details. To avoid falling prey to phishing scams, website owners must follow these techniques:

- **Never click suspicious links, shortened links and open emails that you do not trust.** Make sure you check the source of the email and the sender before opening it in your mailbox.
- **Anti-Phishing extensions** – Every popular internet browser has add-ons that quickly check any website that you visit to confirm if it is a phishing website or not. You will receive a warning when you accidentally visit a phishing website.
- **Only access sites that are secured** – When accessing a website, make sure you see the lock symbol on the left of the address bar and the website address starting with “*HTTPS*”. With modern browsers like Google Chrome, they even pop notifications when you access an unsafe website as “Not Secure”.

5. IP Spoofing

IP address spoofing is a hacking technique used by hackers to inject DDoS attacks and Man-In-The-Middle (MITM) attacks.